

BEN HANKINS

Solutions Architect | Enterprise Cloud, Customer Technical Strategy & AI Integration
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Solutions Architect with 7+ years turning technical complexity into signed deals and production deployments. \$19M in pipeline across 12 enterprise accounts, 70% POC close rate, and a track record working across AWS, GCP, and IBM Cloud with customers in regulated industries. Combines deep infrastructure experience with the communication skills to lead technical discovery, design solutions, and drive them through to close.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Architecture & Strategy	Technical Discovery, Solution Design, Stakeholder Alignment, POC Execution, Customer Enablement, SOC 2 Compliance Architecture, RAG Pipelines
Cloud & Infra	Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, OpenShift), Terraform, Helm, AWS, GCP, IBM Cloud, Docker, CI/CD
Development	TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Python, REST APIs, SQL, Auth (JWT/RBAC)
AI/LLM	Multi-Agent Systems, LLM Architecture, Prompt Engineering (Anthropic, OpenAI, Gemini, Groq)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Solutions Consultant

Oct 2025 - Present

[Sproutflow Studio](#) - [New Orleans, LA](#)

- Run active client engagements end-to-end: lead technical discovery calls, translate business requirements into architecture decisions, and own solution delivery from scoping through production deployment.
- Architected headless commerce migration for client locked into Shopify vendor ecosystem, decoupling frontend from Shopify backend with custom PostgreSQL database and member dashboard. Drove 40% reduction in platform costs and eliminated vendor lock-in constraints.
- Built multi-agent AI system using Claude, GPT-4, and Gemini with specialized agents for market research, financial modeling, and competitive analysis. Automated 60+ hours of manual research per engagement.
- Built and deployed Next.js client applications with Supabase, Postgres (Neon), and AI integrations (OpenAI, Anthropic, Gemini) across healthcare, e-commerce, and service industry verticals.

Site Reliability Engineer

Jan 2025 - Sept 2025

[Prove AI](#) - [Remote](#)

- Led SOC 2 Type II readiness from 34% to 100%, establishing enterprise-grade compliance posture that unblocked \$2M+ in regulated-industry pipeline.
- Maintained 99.9% uptime across 4 production Kubernetes clusters while reducing deployment time 80% through CI/CD pipelines (GitHub Actions, Helm) with integrated testing and Python/Bash automation.
- Built an internal error monitoring dashboard using OpenSearch and Vector DB with severity-based filtering, reducing mean time to resolution by 67% across production incidents.

Cloud Infrastructure Engineer (Post-Sales)

Apr 2023 - Aug 2024

[IBM -- Client Engineering](#) - [Remote](#)

- Promoted from Senior SE to embedded post-sales role managing 3 dedicated enterprise accounts (CenterPoint Energy, AT&T, Cencora), owning Terraform/Helm infrastructure scaling and production support across all three engagements.
- Scaled CenterPoint Energy's OpenShift environments from 2 to 49 using Terraform and Helm, cutting provisioning from 2+ weeks to under 3 hours and directly supporting the \$10.1M deal through production deployment.
- Reduced deployment time by 80% through custom Helm chart templating and GitOps-driven CI/CD pipelines with compliance gates across all embedded accounts.

Senior Solutions Engineer

Feb 2021 - Mar 2023

[IBM -- Client Engineering](#) - [Remote](#)

- Led technical discovery and solution design for 12 enterprise customers (\$19M pipeline) including NBC Universal, Citibank, and AT&T, partnering with account executives and C-level stakeholders to drive multi-cloud adoption across AWS, GCP, and IBM Cloud.
- Served as technical lead on CenterPoint Energy's SAP RISE evaluation, directly supporting \$10.1M deal closure.
- Executed POCs and live technical demos with a 70% close rate, converting evaluations into signed deals across regulated enterprise environments.
- Mentored 3 cohorts of junior SEs through discovery frameworks, POC shadowing, and IBM patent filing.

Solutions Engineer

Dec 2019 - Jan 2021

IBM -- Client Engineering - Austin, TX

- Completed IBM Solutions Engineering program as the fastest in cohort, earning early assignment to enterprise accounts in energy and financial services verticals.
- Delivered Cloud Pak POCs across Data, Security, and Multi-Cloud for enterprise customers; promoted to Senior SE in 14 months based on deal impact and client feedback.

Web Developer

Jan 2019 - Jun 2019

Kortivity - Austin, TX

- Designed, built, and maintained a Vue-based web scraper Chrome extension enabling recruiters to scrape candidate profiles and gather contact information for outreach, directly supporting the company's core recruiting workflow.

PROJECTS

solutions-playbook -- 42-resource SE operational framework used to standardize discovery, POC scoping, and deployment workflows across client engagements.

Stack: Open source -- 42 frameworks and templates

greenlit -- AI resume coaching platform with industry-specific feedback, ATS scoring, keyword analysis, and bullet rewrites.

Stack: Next.js, Supabase, Google Gemini, Anthropic -- free version live at [greenlit.cv](#)

business-plan-writer -- 5-agent AI pipeline for business plan generation. Provider-agnostic architecture.

Stack: Groq, Anthropic, OpenAI, Python -- open source

EDUCATION

B.A. Communication & Media Studies

2017

[Mississippi State University](#)

Software Engineering Bootcamp

2018

[General Assembly](#)

CERTIFICATIONS

Red Hat Certified

AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate (2026)